

Tufte-Style Book

This book template has been designed to conform to Edward R. Tufte's design style, used in his books and handouts. The most defining feature of this design is the large margin on every page and extensive use of sidenotes. This layout means that the central column of text is uncluttered since further descriptions and citations are housed in the margin. Tufte's design style does not end there and numerous other typographic and layout tweaks are present in this template and are described in the documentation template.

Description

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This template consists of two compilable templates: the documentation template – `main.tex` and the minimal template – `book_1_template.tex`. The documentation template contains the documentation for the Tufte-LaTeX class and describes the features of the template with many examples. The minimal template is a stripped-down version with easily-replaceable dummy text to get you writing your own book in the Tufte-LaTeX style without worrying about which blocks of text to remove from the documentation template. It is recommended that you read the documentation template and use it as a guide for writing in the minimal template since it contains many instructions and examples that you will likely require.

Preview

The Design of Tufte's Books

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THE PAGES of a book are usually divided into three major sections: the front matter (also called preliminary matter or prelim), the main matter (the core text of the book), and the back matter (or end matter).

THE FRONT MATTER of a book refers to all of the material that comes before the main text. The following table shows a list of material that appears in the front matter of *The Visual Display of Quantitative Information*, *Envisioning Information*, *Visual Explanations*, and *Beautiful Evidence* along with its page number. Page numbers that appear in parentheses refer to folios that do not have a printed page number (but they are still counted in the page number sequence).

Page content	Books			
	VDQI	EI	VE	BE
Blank half title page	(1)	(1)	(1)	(1)
Frontispiece ²	(2)	(2)	(2)	(2)
Full title page	(3)	(3)	(3)	(3)
Copyright page	(4)	(4)	(4)	(4)
Contents	(5)	(5)	(5)	(5)
Dedication	(6)	(7)	(7)	7
Epigraph	–	–	(8)	–
Introduction	(7)	(9)	(9)	9

² The contents of this page are blank in *VDQI*; blank in *EI* and *VE* this is a frontispiece; and in *BE* contains three epigraphs.

The design of the front matter in Tufte's books varies slightly from the traditional design of front matter. First, the pages in front matter are traditionally numbered with lowercase roman numerals (*e.g.*, i, ii, iii, iv, ...). Second, the front matter page numbering sequence is usually separate from the main matter page numbering. That is, the page numbers restart at 1 when the main matter begins. In contrast, Tufte has enumerated his pages with arabic numerals that share the same page counting sequence as the main matter.

Authorship

Current Version

The Tufte-LaTeX class and documentation template were originally created by the Tufte-LaTeX Developers. The minimal template has been created for this website and the documentation template has been

v1.0 (January 5, 2013)

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